Hustle Hive CIC – Online Safety and Media Policy

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Designated Safeguarding Lead	Gavin Copland, Director
Deputy DSL	Kieron Davis, Director
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner after a significant change in guidance, technology or an incident

1. Purpose

Digital technology gives our learners real opportunities to learn, create and build skills, from CAD and 3D printing to designing and marketing their own products. It also brings safeguarding risks. This policy sets out how Hustle Hive CIC keeps people safe when using the internet, computers and laptops, mobile phones and personal devices, apps and online platforms, social media, messaging, photography and video, artificial intelligence (AI) tools and online games.

Online safety is part of our wider safeguarding arrangements, and this policy should be read alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all children, young people and adults taking part in our activities, and to directors, staff, volunteers, students on placement, contractors and visitors. It covers anyone using Hustle Hive CIC equipment, Wi-Fi or online services, and the use of personal devices during our activities.

We have regard to *Keeping Children Safe in Education* (current edition), the Department for Education's filtering and monitoring standards, the *Prevent duty guidance*, UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018, the Equality Act 2010 and other relevant law.

3. Our approach

We aim to:

- protect learners from harmful and inappropriate online material and contact;
- teach learners to use technology safely, respectfully and responsibly;
- supervise learners whenever they use technology;
- keep effective filtering and monitoring in place on our devices;
- respond quickly to online safety concerns;
- protect personal information and privacy; and
- balance safety with the real educational benefits of technology.

No filtering or monitoring system removes every risk. We combine technology, staff supervision, education and clear procedures.

4. Online risks

Staff should recognise the four areas of online risk set out in *Keeping Children Safe in Education*. Online and offline concerns often overlap, and staff stay alert to new and emerging risks.

Area	What it means	Examples
Content	Being exposed to illegal, inappropriate or harmful material	Pornography, violent content, extremist or hateful material, content promoting self-harm, suicide or eating disorders, misinformation
Contact	Harmful interaction with other people	Grooming, sexual or criminal exploitation, radicalisation, coercion, contact from unknown adults
Conduct	A person's own online behaviour causing harm	Cyberbullying, sending or requesting nude images, abusive messages, sharing personal information, impersonation

Area	What it means	Examples
Commerce	Commercial and financial risks	Scams, phishing, online gambling, inappropriate advertising, financial exploitation

5. Filtering and monitoring

All learner laptops are managed through classroom.cloud (by NetSupport), our classroom management and online safety platform. We use it to meet the Department for Education's filtering and monitoring standards on our devices. It allows us to:

- **control websites:** block harmful or inappropriate sites, and restrict learners to approved sites during activities;
- **see what learners are doing:** staff can view learners' screens live during sessions and step in straight away;
- **flag concerning words and phrases:** classroom.cloud checks what learners type and search for against a database of more than 20,000 words and phrases, including slang. These cover risks such as self-harm and suicide, bullying, sexual and criminal exploitation, radicalisation, drugs and violence, and we can add our own terms. A match creates an alert, with a screenshot, for the DSL;
- **let learners report a concern:** learners can use the Report a Concern button to tell a trusted member of staff about a worry privately; and
- **signpost help:** learners can find details of support organisations, such as Childline, from their device.

Monitoring only takes place on Hustle Hive CIC devices during sessions. Gavin Copland, as DSL, receives all alerts and learner reports, and Kieron Davis covers this when Gavin is unavailable. Alerts and reports are reviewed the same day and handled under our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

Filtering and monitoring are set to suit the age, needs and vulnerabilities of our learners, including learners with SEND. The DSL checks that filtering, monitoring and alerts are working every term, including a test search. The Directors review the system every year, and sooner after a serious incident, a change in technology or a change in our learners' needs.

Technology never replaces supervision. Staff watch screens during sessions and report anything worrying straight away. Any attempt to get around filtering or monitoring must be reported to the DSL. Parents and carers are told about monitoring when their child joins us.

6. Staff responsibilities

All staff and volunteers must:

- use technology professionally and keep the same boundaries online as face to face;
- supervise learners whenever they use technology, and report any online safety concern to the DSL straight away;
- keep passwords and accounts secure, and only use approved Hustle Hive CIC systems for work;
- never access inappropriate or illegal material;
- never contact learners through personal phones, messaging apps or social media, or share personal contact details with them;
- never take photos or videos of learners on personal devices; and
- follow our Safeguarding, Data Protection and Behaviour policies and our staff code of conduct.

7. Learner responsibilities

Learners agree to our Acceptable Use Agreement (see the appendix) before using our devices. Learners must not:

- deliberately look for inappropriate, harmful or illegal content;
- try to get around filtering, monitoring or security;
- use someone else's account or share passwords;
- bully, threaten or harass anyone, or create or share discriminatory content;
- photograph or film anyone without permission, or share other people's personal information;
- send, ask for or share nude or sexual images; or
- download software or damage equipment.

Our response to misuse is proportionate and takes account of the learner's age, needs and circumstances, and of whether the behaviour points to a safeguarding concern.

8. Mobile phones and personal devices

In alternative provision sessions, learners hand their phones to staff at the start of the session. Phones are stored securely and returned at the end of the day or at agreed break times. In holiday clubs and workshops, phones stay switched off and in bags. Exceptions are agreed in advance with the parent or carer and recorded, for example when a phone is used to monitor a medical condition or a young carer needs to be reachable.

Staff should remember that personal devices can use mobile data and are not covered by our filtering. Staff do not search learners' phones. If staff believe a phone contains something harmful or illegal, they ask the learner to switch it off and hand it over, and tell the DSL straight away.

9. Social media

Only the Directors, or people they authorise, may post on Hustle Hive CIC's official social media accounts. Staff must not connect with current learners on personal accounts, discuss learners or confidential matters online, or post anything that could identify a learner without consent.

10. Photography, video and media consent

We may use photographs and video to record learning, celebrate achievements, show projects, provide evidence to commissioners and funders, and promote our work on our website and social media.

- We ask for written consent from parents or carers (and the learner, where appropriate) when a child joins us. The form explains each way images may be used, and consent can be given for some uses and not others.
- Consent can be withdrawn at any time. We stop using the images in future, and remove them from our website and social media where we can.
- We never use a learner's full name alongside their image in public, and we avoid images that show uniforms, locations or other details that could identify where a child lives or goes to school.
- We do not publish images of any learner where there is a safeguarding reason not to, for example a looked-after child or a child at risk from someone, whatever the consent form says. The DSL checks this before anything is published.
- No learner is treated differently if they do not give consent.

Images are only taken on Hustle Hive CIC devices, stored securely, accessed only by authorised staff, and deleted when no longer needed in line with our Records Retention policy. Parents and carers at our events are asked not to post images of other people's children online.

11. Artificial intelligence

AI tools can support learning and enterprise, but bring risks around safety, accuracy, privacy, copyright and fairness. Where AI tools are used:

- they must have a clear educational or business purpose, and learners are supervised;
- we check age limits and terms of use before learners use any tool;
- personal or sensitive information about learners must never be entered into public AI tools;
- staff and learners check AI output and do not assume it is accurate or unbiased;
- learners are taught to use AI honestly and responsibly, including not creating fake or harmful images of real people; and
- AI must never be used to get around safeguarding controls.

AI-generated sexual or abusive images of real people, including other learners, are treated as a serious safeguarding matter and reported to the DSL.

12. Online gaming and entertainment

Where games, videos or other entertainment are used during supervised activities, staff consider age ratings, chat and contact features, in-app purchases and each learner's needs. Access may be restricted or withdrawn if it raises a safeguarding or behaviour concern.

13. Responding to an online safety incident

If an online safety incident happens, staff:

1. make sure the learner and others are safe;
2. do not view, download, copy or forward harmful material more than is necessary;
3. keep any evidence where it is, for example by switching off and securing the device, without making extra copies;
4. report it to the DSL straight away and record what happened the same day; and
5. call 999 if there is an immediate risk of serious harm.

The DSL decides what action to take, including informing parents or carers, the commissioning school, children's services or the police.

Cyberbullying and online harassment

Cyberbullying is treated as seriously as face-to-face bullying. It includes abusive or threatening messages, sharing embarrassing images, impersonation, deliberately excluding someone from online groups, and discriminatory or sexual harassment. Incidents are handled under our Behaviour and Positive Conduct Policy and, where there is a risk of harm, our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

Nude and semi-nude images

Any incident involving creating, requesting, having or sharing nude or semi-nude images of a child, including AI-generated images, is a safeguarding matter. Staff stay calm and do not blame the learner. They must not view, copy, print, forward or delete the image, or ask anyone to send it to them. They secure the device if it is safe to do so and tell the DSL straight away. The DSL follows national guidance for education settings on sharing nudes and semi-nudes.

Online sexual harassment and exploitation

Sexual comments or messages, unwanted sexual images, pressure to send images, sexualised bullying, grooming and threats to share intimate images are never dismissed as banter or part of growing up. They are always reported to the DSL.

Radicalisation and extremism

Staff report any online material or contact suggesting a learner may be at risk of radicalisation to the DSL, who follows our Prevent procedures.

14. Working with commissioning schools

For learners placed with us, we share online safety concerns with the commissioning school's DSL on the same day, take account of any information the school gives us about a learner's online risks, and agree extra controls where a learner needs them.

15. Teaching online safety

We build online safety into our sessions, in ways that suit each learner's age, ability and needs. Topics include privacy and passwords, scams, misinformation, social media and digital footprints, healthy use of technology, cyberbullying, grooming and exploitation, consent and sharing images, using AI responsibly, and how and where to get help. Enterprise projects give us natural opportunities to cover online marketing, safe selling and protecting personal information.

16. Training

All staff receive online safety training as part of their safeguarding induction and annual training. This covers our filtering and monitoring, supervising technology, recognising online risks and how to report concerns.

17. Breaches of this policy

Breaches by learners are handled under our Behaviour and Positive Conduct Policy, while considering whether the behaviour points to a safeguarding need. Breaches by staff are handled under our disciplinary, low-level concerns or allegations procedures. Suspected criminal activity is reported to the police.

18. Review

This policy is reviewed every year, taking account of changes in guidance and technology, new online risks, incidents, and feedback from staff and learners.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection, Behaviour and Positive Conduct, Safer Recruitment, Equality, Diversity & Inclusion, Data Protection, Records Retention and Whistleblowing policies, and our staff code of conduct.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director and DSL		
Kieron Davis	Director and deputy DSL		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		

Appendix: Learner Acceptable Use Agreement

Safe • Respectful • Responsible

Technology is a big part of what we do at Hustle Hive. We want everyone to use computers, the internet and phones safely. Our laptops use classroom.cloud, which lets staff see screens, blocks harmful websites and alerts staff if someone types something that suggests they might be at risk. This is to keep you safe.

I will

- use Hustle Hive equipment carefully and for the activities staff set;
- be kind and respectful to people online;
- keep my passwords and personal information private;
- tell staff, or use the Report a Concern button, if I see something that worries me or someone contacts me in a way that makes me uncomfortable;
- ask permission before photographing, filming or recording anyone;
- hand in my phone, or keep it switched off, when staff ask me to; and
- only use AI tools, websites and apps when staff say I can.

I will not

- look for anything inappropriate, harmful or illegal;
- try to get around the filters or monitoring;
- bully, threaten or upset anyone online;
- make or share racist, sexist, homophobic, transphobic or hateful content;
- send, ask for, save or share nude or sexual images;
- share other people's personal information or pretend to be someone else;
- use AI to make fake or hurtful images of real people; or
- download software or damage equipment.

If something goes wrong

I can talk to a member of staff, or use Report a Concern, if I make a mistake online, someone sends me something upsetting or asks me for photos, I am being bullied, or I am worried about myself or someone else. I won't automatically be in trouble for asking for help. Staff may need to tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead if they are worried about my safety or someone else's.

If I don't follow this agreement, my access to devices or the internet may be limited. Serious incidents may be shared with my parent or carer and my school.

	Name	Signature	Date
Learner			
Staff member			
Parent or carer (if required)			